APPENDIX C

Screening tools for vestibular dysfunction in the paediatric clinic

Screening Tool	Sign to prompt referral for vestibular testing
Farmer's Test	• Can be performed in a baby up to 6 weeks of age • If the infant's eyes deviate towards the side of travel when held under the arms and rotated from side to side, this suggests vestibular function is present.
Office Chair Rotation Test	• The child may sit on the parent's lap and the chair is spun round several times, enough to induce post-rotational nystagmus in the parent. • On stopping the chair, a lack of post-rotational nystagmus suggests vestibular dysfunction.
Halmagyi Head Thrust Test	• Requires child to be able to fixate on a target e.g. a sticker on the clinician's forehead • Turn the child's head quickly and unpredictably to 10-15° neck rotation. • The child's eyes should remain fixated on the target throughout. • If the child's eyes are dragged off the target by the turning of the head followed by a catch-up saccade back to the target after the turning to head, this suggests vestibular dysfunction.